or so. For you, this is prime time right now. This is when you need to be exclusively and relentlessly dedicated to being the best you can be.

'Sometimes it will seem like a burden and a responsibility, though it will – hopefully – more often feel like an honour and a privilege, but you have the capacity to be a force for good in the country. You have been given a great talent. Use it. That is the opportunity.'

I was listening.

He was clearly in full flow and, while it all seemed a little dramatic and overstated, I understood the point he was making. I realised I had reached a crossroads in my career. I knew I needed to take the high road.

Time would tell.

So what happened?

I am always wary of quoting the statistics because they genuinely don't mean that much to me but, for what it's worth …

At the beginning of 2008, I was averaging 36.36 in 33 Test matches and had scored three Test hundreds. Between 1 January 2008, and now, at the time of writing in May 2016, I have averaged 58.26 in a further 73 Test matches and scored an additional 18 Test centuries.

At the beginning of 2008, I was averaging 36.46 in 59 one-day internationals, having scored three ODI hundreds. Between 1 January 2008, and now, in May 2016, I have averaged 63.44 in a further 141 one-day internationals and scored 21 more hundreds.

These numbers are fine, but the stats never tell the whole story.